a feature of security arrangements around infrastructure assets like hydropower dams, radio stations, and electricity transmission towers, as well as economic assets, like gold, tin, and jade mines (Lentz 2013). These 'restricted sites' denote areas of military significance as well as land being used for business purposes that is not to be accessed by the community.[10]

The evolving nature of landmine use in Myanmar is largely the result of an emerging militarized culture that brought knowledge and use of landmines and improvised explosive devices to local communities, either through their targeting or their defence.[11] These factors have constructed an environment of chronic insecurity that has predisposed communities to enact a series of community protection strategies, including multiple patron-client relations and the use of landmines to actively confront and establish control within an environment of chronic insecurity.

CHRONIC INSECURITY AND THE FORMATION OF POLITICAL COMPLEXES IN MYANMAR

Duffield (2008, p. 9) defines chronic emergency in Myanmar as "the exposure of a population to risk and uncertainty by the exercise of arbitrary personal power". In Myanmar, the exercise of arbitrary power is complicated by its multiple sources and characteristics. While populations are in general terms divided between those under the administrative areas of the state or EAGs, in reality conditions are far more complicated, with local militia, border guard forces, business groups, various administrative agencies, faith-based organizations, and INGOs and local CSOs all part of an "emerging political complex" (Duffield 2014).

South (2012) and Jolliffe (2014) describe the influence of patron-client ties on communities in the southeast of Myanmar, along the Thai border. A core theme in their work is that patron-client relationships do not necessarily translate into relationships of protection. Jolliffe (2014, p. 5) says:

> Where there is a lack of universal protection provided by the state or other institutions, civilians become further dependent on [patron-client] relations. Political conflicts and allegiances are therefore typically a function of compatibilities or incompatibilities with regard to expectations about deference or patronage.

However, not all EAGs position themselves locally as protection actors, even though, "groups identifying with ethnic nationalities in